

Call Prep: Maha Abbey (Microsoft)

Meeting: Follow up after Houston AI Tour - Improving/Microsoft **When:** Today, 2026-07-01, 3:30-4:00 PM CT / 4:30-5:00 PM ET **Where:** Teams **Organizer:** Maha Abbey **Attendees:** Maha Abbey, Nick Koury, David O'Hara

How You Got Here

Met Maha at the Microsoft AI Tour stop in Houston. Her CRM lead card flagged MCAPS is looking for a partner for AI responsibility framework implementation. You followed up by email June 9; Maha replied June 22, looping in Nick Koury (Partners collaboration lead, RAI risk and compliance advisory team) and Eoin Mulligan (EMEA lead) for visibility/coverage. Improving has been positioned as a partner in the program she's heading up. Thread has been open since; today's call is the next step. Expect more programmatic detail to surface in this meeting -- no need to guess at it in advance.

Background on Maha Abbey

Title: Dir Risk Mgt - Responsible AI, Microsoft (MCAPS org).

20+ years at Microsoft, Motorola, and TradeStation. Background spans platform recoveries and Gen AI readiness programs, including work that impacted 200+ PMs. Notable clients referenced in her public bio: TD Bank, Desjardins, NBA Media, Veterans Affairs, and Puerto Rico Hacienda.

Core competencies: AI Platform Strategy, Responsible AI Governance, Agile/SAFe delivery. Multilingual.

Read on her current role: she sits in Microsoft's Responsible AI risk and compliance advisory function inside MCAPS (Microsoft Customer and Partner Solutions), which tracks with the CRM lead card describing her as looking for a partner to implement an AI responsibility framework. That's almost certainly the "program" in question -- this call is likely where she defines scope and where Improving fits.

Nick Koury

Partners collaboration lead within Microsoft's RAI risk and compliance advisory team. No additional public background found -- treat as a name to register, not yet a research subject.

Discovery Questions

- What does the AI responsibility framework program actually cover -- governance, technical controls, both?
- What's the timeline and who else is competing for the partner role, if anyone?
- Is this a Microsoft-funded engagement, a co-sell motion, or something Improving would pitch directly to Microsoft's customers?
- What does success look like for her personally in this program -- is this her mandate to build out, or is she executing someone else's?

- Where does Nick Koury's team sit relative to this decision -- gatekeeper, influencer, or just looped in for visibility?

Talking Points

- Anchor on the Houston AI Tour connection and the June follow-up thread -- this isn't a cold call, it's a warm continuation.
- Position Improving's relevant delivery experience (AI governance, risk, compliance-adjacent client work) as directly applicable to what she's building.
- Ask more than pitch. She's heading up something that hasn't fully taken shape yet -- the more of the shape she describes, the better positioned Improving is to propose a fit rather than guess at one.

Watch For

- Whether this is a named, funded program vs. still-forming interest.
- Signals on procurement path (co-sell, direct engagement, RFP).
- Any mention of other partners already in the mix.